

THE 'HUMBLE' BRAG

A Comedic Expressive Reading

Performer: Denzel Aaron Wijaya

School: Cherish Academy

Event: Platform Division — Expressive Reading

Category: Male

Scripture: Matthew 6:1

Time Limit: 4 – 6 minutes

Props: Bag of coins, smartphone

Note: This event must be read — script in hand throughout.

INTRODUCTION

(spoken before the reading — does not count toward time)

My name is Denzel Aaron Wijaya, representing Cherish Academy.

The piece I will present today is called "The 'Humble' Brag."

*It is a comedic reading about the danger of showing off our good deeds,
grounded in the words of Jesus in Matthew 6:1 —*

*"Be careful not to practice your righteousness in front of others
to be seen by them."*

THE READING

Top of the morning, God!

Boy I can't wait to get to church this morning!
I have so much great news to share with everyone.

(pause, thinking)

Let's see...

This week, I was giving 3 whole dollars to that homeless guy
I see on the corner every day.

Three!

Well, it was really two dollars and 57 cents,
and it was all in coins...
and the coins were kinda sticky
as they were in my coin thing in my car
and pop must have spilled on them at one time,
but they WERE money.

I need to make sure my Sunday School class knows all about that.

Then there was my Bible reading schedule;

(use fingers to demonstrate numbers)

3 chapters a day,
2 from the Old Testament and 1 from the New,
plus a chapter of Proverbs every day!

And none of those wimpy translations for me, no sir!
Mine was so tough that they had to send some Rosetta Stone software
just so I can understand it.

THAT's super-sized spirituality, baby.

THAT's worth sharing with everyone.

I also prayed 10 minutes a day...

I know it was 10 minutes because I set my prayer app alarm

(pull out smartphone and wave it around)

I wasn't going to short change you, Lord.

Ten minutes is ten minutes.

Yep, it's like a GPS for the soul.

I can set any voice I want on it,

and I always set the voice of God,

as he and I are so tight.

After ten minutes, I hear:

(deep booming voice)

"Nicely done. Thank you for your gracious ten minutes. You have done well my son. Turn right... towards me!"

(pause, then reflective)

Ya know, I need to update my Facebook status with this news.

(excited again)

Oh and how 'bout my giving!

When the plate goes past me today,

(pick up bag of coins and drop it)

I am going to make a serious impression!

(pick it up and drop it again)

I need to make sure this has the right sound.

To be effective in any presentation,

the sound must project to the back of a room.

(do it one more time, then satisfied)

Ok, that works.

(shocked)

But wait, if all my money is in this bag,
they won't know how much I gave.

(questioning face, hand on chin, thinking)

Hmmmmmm... well...

(arrogant and smug)

I guess that bag will just have to serve
as a demonstration of my giving heart.

(snap fingers — great revelation)

Wait a minute, I'm just ending a fast!
I can break my donut and coffee fast at the café counter!
That will be awesome!

I'll let everyone know how well I did all last week...
You know giving up food like that for a whole week,
well, that just shows you the level of righteous living I can do for you, Lord.

You know, we should promote great righteous accomplishments like this.
After all, I know I am an inspiration to many.
I'll make sure this gets highlighted on our church's web site.
It's definitely homepage material.
Ohh, I got it — Twitter alert!

(questioning face again)

I wonder if the denominational headquarters should be informed?
Getting out this sort of information
can't be left in the hands of a church secretary.

I'll give headquarters a call later this afternoon and let them know.
This kind of righteous living could put our little church on the map!

Yeah, I can direct them to my web site,

"www.DenzelIsRighteous.LORD"

(pause, reflecting)

You know, it's great to do awesome things for Jesus
and to let everyone know about it!

(fake humility)

Because after all, I'm just your humble servant.

Yeah, I can't wait to go to church this morning!

(exits)

LESSON & SCRIPTURE

Lesson: Don't show off your good deeds. Be humble and sincere, because God looks at your heart, not how you impress others.

***"Be careful not to practice your righteousness in front of others
to be seen by them.***

If you do, you will have no reward from your Father in heaven."

— Matthew 6:1